**UNICARE CFRM Glossary**

Date: 23 January 2024

Purpose

This document intends to provide a compilation of terms and definitions related to the processes and components involved in managing complaints and feedback. This glossary helps to standardize the terminology used in handling complaints and feedback, promoting clarity and consistency in communication among our teams and the users of UNICEF CFRMs.

Proposed approach to develop the glossary:

We propose a structured approach that involves a thorough review of guidance and language used by our different teams to refer to terms related to specific processes and systems involved in managing complaints and feedback. These include terms referring to processes such as complaints, feedback, response time, triaging, referrals, opening a case or ticket, closing a case or ticket, ticket resolution, anonymous feedback, and many more.

The CFRM Glossary will cover the terms outlined in the following tables:

1. Overarching Programmatic Themes (such as AAP, PSEA, GBV, ESS, Safeguarding, etc.)
2. Categories of Feedback and Complaints (including thematic/sectoral areas)
3. Terms to refer to the management of CFRMs

**We request all section focal points for this document review to make the suggestions and edits in the document with TRACK CHANGES ON.**

## 1. Overarching Concepts

| Original term | Updated term | Source |
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| **Abuse**<br>Abuse is defined as anything that individuals, institutions or processes do or fail to do that directly or indirectly harms an individual. | Can stay the same | UNICEF Policy on Safeguarding |
| **Accountability to Affected Populations**<br>Accountability to Affected Populations (AAP) is about using power and resources ethically and responsibly. It's about putting the needs and interests of the people and communities organizations serve at the center of decision-making, and ensuring the most appropriate and relevant outcomes for them, while preserving their | UNICEF definition was opted over the IASC AAP definition. | UNICEF AAP Handbook |

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| rights and dignity and increasing their resilience to face situations of vulnerability and crisis. In practice, this means that people – including children and adolescents – have a say in decisions that affect their lives, receive the information they need to make informed decisions, have access to safe and responsive mechanisms to provide feedback or to complain, and have equitable access to assistance in proportion to their needs, priorities and preferences. | | |
| **Child**<br>Child is defined as a person under the age of 18, regardless of the age of majority or age of consent locally. | Can stay the same | ESS Policy draft<br>+<br>UNICEF Policy on Safeguarding |
| **Do no Harm**<br>Do no harm means avoiding exposing people to additional risks through our actions in international development and collaboration as defined by the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development. | Can stay the same | UNICEF Policy on Safeguarding |
| **Environmental and social safeguards and sustainability (ESS)**<br>UNICEF is committed to environmental and social safeguards and sustainability (ESS), not only through the organization's commitments to the realization of child rights and the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs), but also because their achievement depends on practical actions to prevent/reduce the risks and impacts that UNICEF and its partners interventions have on the environment, social aspects, human health of the right-holders and ultimately on children's safe access to essential services and rights. | ESS colleagues, please check if this needs to be updated, and if there are additional terms in the ESS lexicon that should be included | UNICEF's ESS Policy |
| **Emotional abuse**<br>It involves words or acts that harm a person's emotional, intellectual, mental or psychological well-being or development. This may occur as an isolated event or repeatedly. Emotional abuse includes, but is not limited to, any humiliating or degrading treatment (e.g., bad name calling, threats, yelling/screaming/cursing, belittling, persistent shaming); failing to | Can stay the same | UNICEF Policy on Safeguarding |

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| meet a person's emotional needs; and rejecting, ignoring, terrorizing, isolating or confining a person. | | |
| **Exploitation**<br>It is the unfair use of someone for one's own benefit when they cannot bargain for themselves. It often involves force, trickery, coercion or trafficking. Grooming a child or adult in preparation for any form of exploitation and abuse also falls within this category. In relation to children, exploitation includes the worst forms of child labour, which are defined as slavery, debt bondage, commercial sexual exploitation, pornography, forced recruitment of children for use in armed conflict, use of children in drug trafficking and other illicit activities, and all other work harmful or hazardous to the health, safety or morals of girls and boys aged under 18. | Can stay the same | UNICEF Policy on Safeguarding |
| **Gender Based Violence (GBV)**<br>Gender-based violence is an umbrella term for any harmful act that is perpetrated against a person's will, and that is based on socially ascribed (gender) differences between males and females. It includes threats of such violence and acts both in public and private spaces.<br><br>Request GBV colleagues to review the definition here along with the source in the column on the right. | | IASC (2015). Guidelines for Integrating Gender-Based Violence Interventions in Humanitarian Action: Reducing risk, promoting resilience and aiding recovery. Geneva, Switzerland: Inter-Agency Standing Committee. Available from the GBV Guidelines Implementation Support Team website: http://gbvguidelines.org/en/ |
| **Harm**<br>Harm means physical or psychological damage or impact caused to an individual by an individual or organisation, whether it is caused intentionally or accidentally, or by things done or not done. Harm is caused by a broad range of actions or failure to act, including forms of abuse and exploitation. This policy is concerned with harm that has an impact on individuals (e.g., climate change is excluded). | Can stay the same | UNICEF Policy on Safeguarding |
| **Information Provision**<br>Information provision is the exchange of accurate, useful and timely information | The definition has been developed from the UNICEF | UNICEF AAP Handbook |

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| from trusted sources, in an appropriate language and accessible format, and is critical to helping people to make informed decisions. This applies particularly in emergencies, when communication networks are likely to be disrupted, and information on services, safety and family links are needed more than ever. It is a constant, dynamic process that should take place at every stage of a programme or response until its completion. | AAP Handbook (page 44) | |
| **Neglect**<br>It is an ongoing failure to meet a person's basic needs. A child may be left hungry or dirty, without adequate clothing, shelter, supervision or medical or health care, or may be put in danger or not protected. A child may suffer any of the other types of harm listed in the scope of this policy as a result of neglect. | Can stay the same | UNICEF Policy on Safeguarding |
| **Physical abuse**<br>The non-accidental and non-defensive use of physical force towards a person, including children, that deliberately or inadvertently causes injury. This may include hitting, shaking, throwing, poisoning, burning or scalding, drowning, suffocating or otherwise causing non-accidental physical harm. It includes the corporal punishment of children. | Can stay the same | UNICEF Policy on Safeguarding |
| **Protection from Sexual Exploitation and Abuse**<br>Protection from Sexual Exploitation and Abuse (PSEA) refers to measures taken to prevent, and respond to, Sexual Exploitation and Abuse (SEA). These measures aim to ensure safe and accessible reporting, good-quality assistance for survivors of SEA, and enhanced accountability among organizations, including in investigations into allegations of SEA.<br><br>Request PSEA colleagues to add their definition here along with the source in the column on the right since it was difficult to identify an official definition that could match it. | | |

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| **Risk communication**<br>Usually related to public health interventions, risk communication is the real-time exchange of information, advice and opinions with people who are at risk, to assist them in contributing to decisions that affect them and to encourage them to adopt protective and safe behaviours. | Can stay the same. | UNICEF AAP Handbook |
| **Safeguarding**<br>The actions taken to prevent and respond to harm caused to any individual as a result of their contact with UNICEF or the work of the organization. | Can stay the same unless safeguarding colleagues would like to update this. | UNICEF Policy on Safeguarding |
| **Sexual Exploitation and Abuse**<br>Sexual Exploitation refers to actual or attempted manipulation, for sexual purposes, of someone who is in a position of vulnerability, including where there are differential power relations. This includes (but is not limited to) profiting financially, socially or politically from the sexual exploitation of another person. Sexual Abuse refers to the actual or threatened physical intrusion of a sexual nature, whether by force or under unequal or coercive conditions. Sexual Exploitation and Abuse (SEA) by UN personnel, their partners or other aid workers against the people they serve constitute one of the most serious breaches of accountability.<br><br>**Sexual Abuse**<br>Sexual abuse, according to the United Nations Secretary-General's Bulletin, is actual or threatened intrusion of a sexual nature, whether by force or under unequal or coercive conditions.38 Under this policy, UNICEF includes any sexual activities where the survivor could not, did not or did not have the capacity to freely consent. These activities may involve physical contact, including assault by penetration or non-penetrative acts such as masturbation, kissing, rubbing and touching through clothing. They may also include non-contact activities, such as involving children in looking at, or in the | | UNICEF AAP Handbook<br><br>UNICEF Policy on Safeguarding |

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| production of, sexual images, watching sexual activities or encouraging children to behave in sexually inappropriate ways.<br><br>**Sexual exploitation**<br>It is any actual or attempted abuse of a position of vulnerability, differential power or trust for sexual purposes, including, but not limited to, profiting monetarily, socially or politically from the sexual exploitation of another.40 Under this policy, this includes a person giving or receiving any kind of benefit in exchange for sex with them or another person. Sexual exploitation does not always involve physical contact; it can also occur online. | | UNICEF Policy on Safeguarding |
| **Survivor/victim**<br>It refers to a person who is, or has been, exploited or abused, including through sexual exploitation or abuse. 'Victim' is a term often used in the legal and medical sectors, while the term 'survivor' is generally preferred in the psychological and social support sectors because it implies resiliency. | Can stay the same | UNICEF Policy on Safeguarding |

2. **Categories of Feedback**

| Category Title | Definition | Comment | Source |
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| **Request for Information** | This category is used for all feedback, regardless of they are phrased as a question, related to information, like information about services, information about the general situation in the country or in the country of origin (if relevant), information about specific agencies or specific programs, information about how to register or access services, etc. This category should also be used for all questions that are answered directly at the first interaction. | The category name and definition stay the same as what has been developed by the IASF AAP TF. | IASC AAP TF |

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| **Request for Assistance and/or Services** | This category is used for feedback that are specific requests for assistance and services. This includes new requests and follow-up from previous requests. This category includes issues like requesting to be inserted into a beneficiaries list, to requesting specific services related to registration and access to sectoral interventions, including documentation services (exception to this category are all feedback related to any other category in this list). This may also include technical challenges or issues related to updating, receiving, validating, verifying, or legalizing documents necessary to access humanitarian aid and assistance. This category should also be used for everything related to support with physical access, costs/finances, language and communication requests, and other specialized services. | The category name and definition stay the same as what has been developed by the IASF AAP TF.<br><br>⍰ Request the group to explain here why we have services mentioned. | IASC AAP TF |
| **Non-sensitive Complaints** | This category should be used for all complaints, with the exclusion of everything related to Misconduct and PSEA. This category includes any complaints about services, goods or humanitarian staff or about general humanitarian operations. This category is used for all feedback related to services used or available or unavailable. This includes feedback related to delayed, missed, refused, or reduced assistance, feedback about poor quality of services, and feedback about the quality of the staff and volunteers delivering assistance. | The category name has been updated to Non-sensitive Complaints and the definition stays the same as what has been developed by the IASF AAP TF.<br><br>★ This category is meant for non-sensitive complaints | IASC AAP TF |
| Complaints about | All UNICEF staff and complementary personnel, in both their personal and professional lives, are prohibited from | ★ The definition chosen is UNICEF's | Allegations of |

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| **Prohibited Actions** | attempting, soliciting, encouraging, assisting or engaging in acts that may cause harm to individuals. The following is a non-exhaustive list of prohibited actions that may amount to misconduct and/or wrongdoing, in accordance with UNICEF policies, procedures and any applicable contractual arrangements:<br><br>1. Sexual exploitation and abuse, including exchange of money, employment, goods or services for sex or sexual favours. The prohibition includes any form of exploitation and abuse that happens digitally and online and acts associated with child sexual abuse materials. Deliberately exposing a child to any sexual activity or material is prohibited.<br><br>2. Any sexual relationship between those providing assistance and protection and a person benefiting from such assistance and protection that involves improper use of rank or position or exchange of anything for sex or sexual favors.<br><br>3. Sexual activity with children (persons under the age of 18). This is prohibited regardless of whether it is legal locally and regardless of marital status. Mistaken belief regarding the age of a child is not a defense.<br><br>4. Entering into marriage or a similar union with a child.<br><br>5. Exploiting persons through any form of human trafficking, forced or exploitative labor.<br><br>6. Engaging a child as a household servant or otherwise economically exploiting children or engaging them in work that is likely to interfere with | definition for Prohibited Actions. If we wish to use the IASC's definition for Allegations of Misconduct or merge the two definitions, please add your comments here.<br>★ IASC definition includes all reports of fraud, misconduct, and all breaches on the code of conduct of humanitarian organizations, including PSEA allegations. SEA is A breach of the provision of the ST/SGB/2003/13 and IASC Six Core Principles relating to PSEA. SEA constitutes forms of gender-based violence that have been reported, specifically perpetrated by aid workers including personnel involved in humanitarian, development | Misconduct: IASC AAP TF<br><br>Prohibited Actions: UNICEF's Policy on Safeguarding |

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| | their education or otherwise negatively affect their development, including child household servants or the worst forms of child labor.<br><br>7. Engaging in any form of violence, including physical violence against any person or being verbally abusive towards persons or subjecting them to other degrading or humiliating language or treatment.<br><br>8. Neglecting or negligently treating children who may be under our care in our professional capacity in a manner that could cause significant harm to said children.<br><br>9. Neglecting or negligently treating children in our personal capacity as the parent, legal guardian or caregiver of the child in a manner that could cause significant harm to said children. This includes exposing children under our care to domestic violence, deliberately exposing them to violence or cruelty, or encouraging dangerous or illegal activities.<br><br>10. Engaging in practices harmful to individuals, including female genital mutilation/cutting, amputations,20 bindings, scarring, burning, branding and violent or degrading initiation rites. | programs and peace-keeping operations | |
| **Safety and Security** | This category includes feedback related to disputes over land, labor disputes, security Incidents or conflict, threats to dignity, threats to the physical safety of persons or groups, cyber security and data breach, and psychological and mental safety. This also includes on-going safety issues like circulation of weapons, and general criminal | ★ The additions in the definition were the ones we discussed during the workshop. Request the group to review if this is a definition we | IASC AAP TF |

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| | activities like theft, robbery, corruption or bribery and diversion of assistance. | can sign off on or if any additions need to be made. | |
| **Observations and Suggestions** | This category should be used for all feedback that is relying on an observation about the humanitarian situation or the response, and that do not require any actions or any provisions of services, information or support. This category is also used for suggestions about better ways to deliver aid or to address challenges, as well as for positive feedback. | ★ Request the group to move away from UNICEF's term 'Feedback and Observations' to 'Observations and Suggestions' as developed by the IASC TF since they both would be considered feedback. | IASC AAP TF |
| **CFRM Interaction issues** | This category should be used for all issues related to interactions, feedback that may have been interrupted, not clear, or not understandable. This should also be selected if an interaction was ended because the feedback provider was abusive, unable to communicate or withdraws from providing feedback. | ★ Name change from 'Interaction Issues' to 'CFRM Interaction Issues' for the sake of clarity | IASC AAP TF |
| NEW CATEGORY:<br><br>**Data Subject Requests** | This category shall be used when anyone who has provided personally identifiable data/information to UNICEF (any system) wishes to interact with their data, i.e., request correction, deletion, withdraw consent to some or all forms of processing, etc. | ★ Request Jackie to provide the definition for this category and include the source in the last column | TBD |

**Thematic/Sectoral areas**

| Sector | Updated term/Comments | Source |
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| **Education**<br>This sector is marked when the feedback is related to formal or informal education, both for adults and | | IASC AAP TF's definitions for |

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| children. This sector is also marked when the feedback is related to vocational training, internships, fellowships or education grants, and in general professional development (see exception below under Complimentary Pathways) | | Operational Relevance |
| **Camp Coordination and Camp Management (CCCM)** This sector is marked when the feedback is related to the coordinated activities implemented by various humanitarian actors to provide services to displaced populations within any communal settings (i.e. camps, informal settlements, collective centers); including when the services are provided by national authorities, and it is their responsibility to administer such sites. | | IASC AAP TF's definitions for Operational Relevance |
| **Early recovery** This sector is marked when the feedback is related to Early Recovery, which is a multidimensional process of recovery that begins in a humanitarian setting. It is guided by development principles that seek to build on humanitarian programs and catalyze sustainable development opportunities. This includes Emergency employment, conflict prevention and peacebuilding, disaster risk reduction, human mobility, rule of law, human rights, health, financial resilience, etc. This sector should be marked only if the overall response has activated this specific cluster or a similar one. | | IASC AAP TF's definitions for Operational Relevance |
| **Telecommunications** This sector should be marked when the feedback is related to communications services and voice and internet connectivity. This includes telephony, support to broadcasters, like radio stations, internet connectivity, Security Communication Systems, and UAS coordination. This cluster can be deployed to support for affected population with services like: call centers; free internet spots; etc. This sector should be marked when the feedback is related to any of these services or needs. | | IASC AAP TF's definitions for Operational Relevance |
| **Food security** This sector should be marked when the feedback is related to one of the four pillars of food security (availability, access, utilization and stability). This includes any feedback related to physical and economic access to sufficient, safe and nutritious food, including food distributions, food vouchers, market-based interventions, manipulation of food assistance, risks and security for beneficiaries accessing food, etc. | | IASC AAP TF's definitions for Operational Relevance |
| **Health** | | IASC AAP TF's definitions for |

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| This sector should be marked when the feedback is related to health, health issues, maternal health, public health and related concerns, questions or misinformation about health. This sector is also marked when the feedback is related to hospitals, mental health facilities, retirements homes, clinics or health emergency services. This category should also be used for anyone reporting diseases, sick people or possible issues that may affect people's health, like pollution hazards or waste hazards. | | Operational Relevance |
| **Logistics**<br>This sector is marked when the feedback is related to logistical arrangements, like transportation for refugees or stateless and displaced people, temporary accommodation for migrants or refugees, arrangements of flights and trains to move people to safety. This sector is also marked if the feedback is related to possible logistical issues like roads being blocked, access to transportation, or requests for logistical support. | | IASC AAP TF's definitions for Operational Relevance |
| **Protection**<br>This sector should be used to identify all feedback that are related to the protection of people, communities, groups and individuals. Protection here refers to both legal and physical protection, and encompasses all activities aimed at ensuring full respect for the rights of the individual in accordance with human rights law, international humanitarian law (which applies in situations of armed conflict) and refugee law. This may include but it is not limited to specialized services, such as legal aid, family tracing and reunification services, facilitating refugee registration, etc. (See below for Child Protection) | | IASC AAP TF's definitions for Operational Relevance |
| **Shelter**<br>This sector should be marked when the feedback is related to safe, dignified and appropriate shelter for communities. This may include shelter material, like plastic sheeting, shelter kits, tents, or other solutions, and longer-term needs, transitional shelter, building or reconstruction of houses, capacity building, and related matters. | | IASC AAP TF's definitions for Operational Relevance |
| **WASH**<br>This sector should be marked when the feedback is related to water, sanitation and hygiene (WASH) activities of issues. This includes access to drinkable water, building of water wells, latrines, open defecation issues, hygiene education and capacity building, including outbreak of diseases related to WASH, like Cholera. | | IASC AAP TF's definitions for Operational Relevance |

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| **Nutrition**<br>This sector should be marked if the feedback is related to interventions whose primary objective is to address nutrition and that target the immediate causes of undernutrition. This includes reports of children malnutrition, access to safe water and food, feedback on the nutritional status of food, food preparation and eating habits, and health status as related to food intake. | | IASC AAP TF's definitions for Operational Relevance |
| **CASH assistance**<br>This sector is marked when the feedback is related to a Cash and Voucher Assistance (CVA) program, from the request of information about it, to inquiries on criteria, to complaints about not being part of the beneficiary's pool. This sector is used to mark any type of feedback that relates to cash assistance regardless of if it is conditional or unconditional, inter-agency or managed by an individual agency or organization. This includes reporting issues and problems with the cash assistance received, changing information that will affect the cash amount provided and similar technical issues. | | IASC AAP TF's definitions for Operational Relevance |
| **Livelihoods**<br>This sector should be used for feedback related to activities undertaken by a typical household to ensure a living. For example, feedback related to crops and livestock, farm, off-farm and non-farm activities, including material to farm, seeds, machinery, capacity building, etc. This also includes market-related issues, like feedback related to the increase in prices of commodities, changes in the exchange rate, and devaluation/inflation issues. This sector should also be used for employment-related feedback, including requests for employment opportunities. | | IASC AAP TF's definitions for Operational Relevance |
| **Local integration**<br>This sector should be used to mark all feedback related to the complex and gradual process with legal, economic, social and cultural dimension of integration of refugees/migrants/IDPs with a host population. This includes possible problems and violent clashes, issues related to the sharing of resources and discrimination. It also includes feedback related to activities implemented by humanitarian organizations aimed at improving local integration, like social cohesion activities, dialogues and in general community engagement activities aimed at social cohesion. | | IASC AAP TF's definitions for Operational Relevance |
| **Housing, land, property**<br>This sector should be used for feedback related to rights over immovable property, in the context of emergency | | IASC AAP TF's definitions for |

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| response. HLP include laws, but also practices, customs, and attitudes that revolve around specific rights to land and property, including collective ownership, land related violence or conflict, access to land and property, farming land and its related ownership rights, etc. | | Operational Relevance |
| **Child protection**<br>This sector should be used to mark all feedback related to the safeguarding of children from violence, exploitation, abuse, and neglect. Feedback under this sector include feedback from people identifying signs of potential harm, feedback about the response to allegations or suspicions of abuse, request for providing support and services to protect children, and issues related to holding those who have harmed children accountable. | | IASC AAP TF's definitions for Operational Relevance |
| **Gender Based Violence (GBV)**<br>This sector should be used for all feedback related to physical, sexual, mental or economic harm inflicted on a person because of socially ascribed power imbalances between males and females. This includes feedback from people identifying signs of potential harm, feedback about the response to allegations or suspicions of abuse, request for providing support and services to protect individuals, and issues related to holding those who have harmed others accountable. | | IASC AAP TF's definitions for Operational Relevance |
| **Mine action**<br>This sector should be used for feedback related to humanitarian activities or risks and challenges related to the impact of explosive ordnance. They include the removal and clearance of explosive items, provision of risk education to impacted communities, as well as support to persons injured physically or mentally by explosives items. | | IASC AAP TF's definitions for Operational Relevance |
| **Non-Food Items (NFI)**<br>This sector should be used for feedback related to Core Relief Items (CRIs), also known as Non Food items (NFIs), which are items other than food used in humanitarian contexts, such as mattresses, blankets, plastic sheets, containers for water, cooking utensils and hygiene kits. Depending on the situation, NFI can also include fans, emergency lights, mosquito nets, soap, etc. | | IASC AAP TF's definitions for Operational Relevance |

3. **Terms to refer to the management of CFRMs**

| Original term | Updated term | Source |
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| **Case Closure**<br>Case closure refers to the action that takes place when no further intervention is required to resolve an individual feedback case. A case may be closed due to a) it being outside of the scope of a CFM, b) resolution is reached through the use of feedback management tools (repository of key messaging/talking points, directory of partner services, or referral framework) or c) the individual providing feedback has withdrawn or no longer wishes to proceed. | Do we call it case or Ticket? | IASC AAP TF |
| **Case Escalation**<br>The process of bringing a case to the attention of stakeholder(s) with more authoritative or decision-making power, for the purposes of appropriately addressing information that is critical and/or sensitive. | Do we call it case or Ticket? | IASC AAP TF |
| **Case Resolution**<br>Resolution refers to the event where a feedback case is responded to in a manner that is satisfactory to the individual seeking response to feedback. | Do we call it case or Ticket? | IASC AAP TF |
| **Case Referral**<br>The transfer of information connected to an instance of feedback, including the interaction(s), feedback content and response actions, to a referral focal point with the necessary resources for resolution (that fall outside of those possessed by the feedback mechanism alone). See: Referral mechanism definition (Step 1) | Do we call it case or Ticket? | IASC AAP TF |
| **Closing the feedback loop**<br>The process of communicating to feedback providers what has been done in response to their feedback. It is essential to explain and discuss how the feedback was taken into account, what was feasible to do (or not), and the rationale behind these decisions. | Can stay the same | IASC AAP TF |
| **Coding Feedback Data**<br>Coding is a technique used to attach qualitative data to particular subjects or classes in order to reduce data to a form in which they can be tracked and analysed more easily. Coding helps capture key | Can stay the same | IASC AAP TF |

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| points that can be used as the basis for further analysis and to identify themes in community feedback data without losing meaning. Codes can be analysed quantitatively or qualitatively, and/or help to identify relationships and patterns in the data. They may be further organized into categories. [1] | | |
| **Coding Frame and Codebook**<br>A coding frame is a guiding scheme for the process of organising open, unstructured feedback comments. It provides an overview of the categories, codes and criteria used to classify community feedback. It is supported by a codebook, which provides detailed descriptions of the categories and codes, as well as example feedback comments. The coding frame and codebook ensure that everyone involved in the coding and analysis process has the same understanding of the coding process. | Can stay the same | IASC AAP TF |
| **Community Feedback**<br>Community feedback are information generated by community members - adults and children - and can include any type of information, such as questions, suggestions, observations, beliefs, concerns, complaints[2] and statements of thanks. Community feedback can therefore be positive, neutral or negative information. It can be received through any kind of feedback channel, both formal or informal ones, be structured or unstructured, received directly by the stakeholder who will use and act on the information, or indirectly via intermediary stakeholders. | Can stay the same | IASC AAP TF |
| **Feedback Collector**<br>The person receiving and documenting the information shared by community members. This includes staff documenting insights during their regular activities, as well as an organization or third-party staff or volunteers specifically tasked to collect and document community feedback. | Can stay the same | IASC AAP TF |
| **Complaints and feedback mechanisms**<br>Complaints and feedback mechanisms are systems that allow Affected Populations to express their views of their experiences of the work of a humanitarian agency or the wider humanitarian system. When a | The Community Feedback Mechanism definition by the IASC AAP TF was ommited here. | UNICEF AAP Handbook |

[1] ICRC (2017): *Acquiring and analyzing data in support of evidence-based decisions*, p.201.

[2] In practice, using the word complaint in the context of a feedback mechanism has often discouraged children and adults from reporting their feedback, especially safeguarding concerns (as it implied the need for evidence or a level of certainty when using "complaint"). We recommend avoiding this word where possible and consulting communities - adults and children - on what terminology to use.

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| mechanism is managed by one organization but used to cover the mandate of many, it is referred to as a 'common' mechanism. If it is jointly established and managed by more than one organization, it is referred to as a 'collective' mechanism. | | |
| **Consent**<br>Consent is any free, voluntary and informed decision that is given for a specified purpose and that is based on an understanding of the implications and consequences of an action. An example is providing personal information to an organization. Consent must be given for all proposed uses of the information, and for whether the identity of the participant will remain confidential. Even if consent is given, the information collector has an obligation to assess the implications of the use of information for the safety of the person providing it and for others involved. | The IASC AAP TF definition for Informed Consent was omitted here. | UNICEF AAP Handbook |
| **Data Anonymization**<br>Process by which personal data is irreversibly altered, either by removing or modifying the identifying variables, in such a way that the person that provided the data can no longer be identified directly or indirectly. [3] | Can stay the same | IASC AAP TF |
| **Data Categorization**<br>The process of grouping data into categories according to specific criteria, which usually means that these data have something in common, such as a similar value (in the case of quantitative data) or a similar feature (in the case of qualitative data). Categories can be overlapping or non-overlapping, and a piece of data may be categorized in a number of different ways, depending on the analyst's perspective. [4] | Can stay the same | IASC AAP TF |
| **Data Collection**<br>Data collection is the process of documenting community feedback in a systematic way. Solutions for data collection can be low-tech (e.g., no internet and paper documentation) or high-tech (e.g. involving the complex configuration of software or devices that are linked to WiFi-dependent or cloud-based storage solutions). | Can stay the same | IASC AAP TF |
| **Data Criticality and Sensitivity** | Can stay the same | IASC AAP TF |

[3] The Centre for Humanitarian Data: *Glossary*. https://centre.humdata.org/glossary/

[4] ICRC (2017): *Acquiring and analyzing data in support of evidence-based decisions*, p.208.

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| Criticality of feedback data relates to the importance of feedback information that may require a time-sensitive or escalated response process. Data sensitivity concerns information that should be protected from access or disclosure due to its sensitive nature (see definition for sensitive feedback in Step 2). Both criticality and sensitivity require classification parameters that determine the standard course of action or response (see definition for case escalation in Step 3). Although often sensitive cases are also critical cases, it is possible that feedback may be non-sensitive in nature and still require urgent action. | | |
| **Data Disaggregation**<br>Statistical reports that are separated according to particular criteria. For the humanitarian sector this is most commonly sex and age. [5] | Can stay the same | IASC AAP TF |
| **Data protection**<br>Data protection is the systematic application of a set of institutional, technical and physical measures that preserve the right to privacy with respect to the collection, storage, use and disclosure of personal data. Data protection safeguards the right to privacy by regulating the processing of personal data, providing individuals with rights over their data, and setting up systems of accountability and clear obligations for those who control, analyze or process the data. Strong data protection can empower individuals and deter harmful practices, such as destruction, loss, alteration, exploitation, unauthorized disclosure of, or access to, personal data. | Can stay the same | UNICEF AAP Handbook |
| **Data Sharing Agreement (DSA)**<br>Agreement that establishes the terms and conditions that govern the sharing of personal data or sensitive non-personal data. It is primarily used for data sharing between two parties and typically established at the country level. In accordance with data protection frameworks, signing a DSA is required for the sharing of personal data. [6] | Can stay the same | IASC AAP TF |
| **Data Storage**<br>The process of retention of data (in most cases, digital data). For feedback data, this means the locations where feedback is safely kept at each stage of its life cycle, including where it goes just after it is | Can stay the same | IASC AAP TF |

[5] Sphere (2018): *Sphere Glossary*

[6] IASC (2021): *Guidance on Data Responsibility in Humanitarian Action,* p. 29.

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| collected, where it exists during and after processing, as well as - to a certain degree - where it is distributed to. | | |
| **Data System**<br>A data system for community feedback refers to the organisation of data-driven tools and processes that underpin a feedback mechanism's functional requirements. | Can stay the same | IASC AAP TF |
| **Data Transfer**<br>Sharing data privately with partners or making it available publicly for open access. [7] | Can stay the same | IASC AAP TF |
| **Feedback**<br>Feedback is a positive, negative or neutral statement of opinion, shared by a community member with an organization regarding its programmes and/or the behaviour of its staff and representatives. Feedback can be either solicited (collected on pre-determined indicators and via specific channels) or unsolicited (information shared about any issue, at any time). | Can stay the same | UNICEF AAP Handbook |
| **Feedback Case**<br>When we refer to a case (case referral, case escalation, first case resolution, etc.) we are referring to the entire portfolio for that case, including the interaction(s), feedback content, and response actions connected to a specific instance of feedback. A case may require multiple interactions between feedback data collectors and the individual providing feedback before it can be closed (and reported as such). | Can stay the same | IASC AAP TF |
| **Feedback Content**<br>The specific meaning of a community insight shared through a feedback channel. | Can stay the same | IASC AAP TF |
| **Information Sharing Protocol (ISP)**<br>An Information Sharing Protocol serves as the foundation for a collective approach to responsible information and data exchange. While typically established at the system-wide level, ISPs may also be established at the cluster/sector and organization level as needed. [8] | Can stay the same | IASC AAP TF |
| **Interpretation**<br>The process of looking across themes and narratives in the feedback data and working out what it all means. It is sometimes referred to as a second level | Can stay the same | IASC AAP TF |

[7] The Centre for Humanitarian Data (2019): *Data responsibility guidelines*, p. 20.

[8] IASC (2021): *Information Sharing Protocol.*

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| analysis.[9] The process of interpreting community feedback data necessitates the involvement of diverse stakeholders with knowledge of the context and operational realities, including diverse representatives of the community, and must not be conducted by the feedback team alone. | | |
| **Personal Data (or personal information, personal identifiable information)**<br>Any information relating to an identified or identifiable natural person ('data subject'); an identifiable natural person is one who can be identified, directly or indirectly, in particular by reference to an identifier such as a name, an identification number, location data, an online identifier or to one or more factors specific to the physical, physiological, genetic, mental, economic, cultural or social identity of that natural person.[10] | Can stay the same | IASC AAP TF |
| **Quality Assurance**<br>A process with the objective of preventing and identifying errors, both human and technological, from impeding the effectiveness of the community feedback mechanism. In addition to this, the process maintains relevance of feedback tools and processes, and preserves the trust of feedback mechanism stakeholders through the aforementioned activities. | Can stay the same | IASC AAP TF |
| **Referral System/Mechanism**<br>A referral system is a mechanism that enables the needs or gaps identified through community feedback to be comprehensively managed using resources beyond those offered by a single feedback channel or mechanism.<br>It consists of communication protocols and channels by which feedback comments are shared with internal project teams and administrative departments for review and action, as well as shared with peer organizations in the cluster system, implementing partners and government counterparts for information and action because feedback falls outside the scope of an organization's mandate and project activities. | Can stay the same | IASC AAP TF |
| **Statistical disclosure control (SDC)**<br>Technique used in statistics to assess and lower the risk of a person or organization being re-identified | Can stay the same | IASC AAP TF |

[9] See: UNICEF Social Science Analysis Cell (2020): *CASS Methodology Guide* and INTRAC (2017): *Qualitative analysis*.
[10] OCHA (2019): Data Responsibility Guidelines, p.49.

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| from the results of an analysis of survey or administrative data, or in the release of microdata. [11] | | |
| **Sensitive Feedback**<br>Any information that can put the person sharing it, or other people linked to it, at risk and needs to be handled with care. [12] It can involve serious allegations related to breaches of national- or international law, or human rights law concerning the protection (safety, dignity and rights) of affected populations, or any violation of the humanitarian Code of Conduct or safeguarding policies. [13] | Can stay the same | IASC AAP TF |
| **Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs)**<br>A set of detailed instructions related to core processes that are compiled to help the feedback mechanism team carry out their functional responsibilities. The objective of establishing SOPs is to achieve efficiency, quality outputs and uniformity of performance, while reducing miscommunication and failure to document compliance with the minimum requirements. | Can stay the same | IASC AAP TF |
| **Triage of Feedback Data**<br>Triage of community feedback is the process of prioritizing response to feedback according to its criticality and/or sensitivity. This activity, performed at the time of receiving and initially documenting the data ensures all feedback comments are treated appropriately and shared with those who can take action to address it in a time-sensitive manner. | Can stay the same | IASC AAP TF |
| **Triangulation**<br>The process of combining or comparing several sources and/or observations on a given topic, with the aim of increasing confidence in the result by decreasing the bias associated with 'one side of the story'. The end goal of triangulation is to reveal converging results, complementary results and contradictions. [14] | Can stay the same | IASC AAP TF |
| **Validation**<br>The process of discussing the interpretations, conclusions and recommendations arising out of the data analysis with those who shared their feedback. Feedback providers are asked if they agree with the findings, and to correct things that might have not | Can stay the same | IASC AAP TF |

[11] The Centre for Humanitarian Data (2019) *Guidance Note on Statistical Disclosure Control*.

[12] Inter-Agency Standing Committee (2021). Data Responsibility in Humanitarian Contexts. Operational Guidance, p.30.

[13] Danish Refugee Council (forthcoming). Community Feedback and Complaint Response Mechanism, p. 19.

[14] Flick, Uwe (2009): *An introduction to Qualitative Research*,

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| been interpreted correctly. Validation is especially relevant if the feedback providers were not involved in the interpretation and development of conclusions, which is the ideal scenario. | | |

Potential addition to non-sectoral action to manage CFRM:

Analytical Framework (IASC AAP TF)

Analytical frameworks are models that aim to guide and facilitate sense making and understanding.[15] Communities and their diverse feedback are complex, multifaceted and multidimensional, and understanding how community perspectives vary across groups and locations, requires a structured and consistent approach. The Community Feedback Analytical Framework thus seeks to provide this structure, offering a logic to the way in which feedback data are analysed, triangulated, and discussed with the relevant stakeholders of a humanitarian response.

[15] See: Chataigner, Patrice (2017): *Analytical Framework Review Report*.